Your House Shortlist – Santa Clara Area

Santa Clara · Sunnyvale · Mountain View · North San Jose · prepared 27 October 2026 · budget **$2,000,000** · single-family, 3+ bd / 2+ ba, garage, 1,400+ sq ft · commute to Marvell (5488 Marvell Ln, Santa Clara) under 20 min

Summary

I reviewed 70 active listings on Homes.com, cross-checked on MLSListings, Redfin, Zillow and brokerage sites, across Santa Clara, Sunnyvale, Mountain View and North San Jose. 29 homes met (or came within 5% of) your size, bed/bath and budget rules; research agents then checked each one's grocery, school, hospital, safety, hazards and commute to Marvell. **Key finding:** Santa Clara is the sweet spot - its single-family median is $1.82M ($1,212/sq ft, MLSListings Sep 2026), so $2M buys a full 1,500-1,800 sq ft house 15-20 minutes from Marvell. Sunnyvale (~$2.8M median) and Mountain View ($2.98M) only offer flips, small lots or bidding-war bait at this price; North San Jose / Berryessa gives the most space but some homes are 20-25 minutes away.

My recommendation

SC-7 · 2831 Monroe St, Santa Clara 95051
$1,988,888 ($1,096/sq ft) · 1,815 sq ft · lot 7,000 (corner) · 4/2 bd/ba · 2-car attached garage · built 1958 · HOA None · Active, ~44-68 days; cut $410K from $2.499M on 9/9/2026 · Open listing

Why this one
• **Top score (21/25) with the lowest price per sq ft of the leaders** - ~$1,096/sq ft vs. the $1,212 Santa Clara median.
• **Most house for the money:** 1,815 sq ft, 4 bed / 2 bath, single story, central air, attached 2-car garage on a 7,000 sq ft corner lot.
• **Motivated seller:** cut from $2.499M to $1.989M ($410K) and relisted - good leverage to negotiate below asking.
• **Commute and services:** 15-20 min to Marvell, Kaiser Santa Clara ER ~2 mi, Bracher Elementary 0.3 mi, no HOA.
• **Nearby:** Lucky/Safeway on El Camino ~1 mi (est.); Bracher Elem (Santa Clara USD) 6/10, 0.27 mi; Bowers 7/10 0.43 mi; Kaiser Santa Clara Medical Center (ER) ~2 mi.

Watch-outs: the listing says the expansion is 'fully permitted' - get copies before offering; the corner lot gets more street traffic; Bracher Elementary rates 6/10 (Bowers 7/10 nearby). If you'd rather have an ADU for rental income, SC-5 scores the same.

Top 10 alternatives

#	Home	Price	Size	Commute	Score	Why consider it
1	**SC-5** 2527 Malone Pl, Santa Clara 95050 Open listing	$1.995M $1,234/sq ft	1,617 sq ft 3/2 + 1/1 ADU	15-18 min	21/25	Ties for the top score: 1,617 sq ft 3/2 ranch plus a permitted 1-bed ADU with its own address, attached 2-car garage, 15-18 min to Marvell, 1.5 mi to Kaiser. $1.995M after a $300K cut - right at budget, negotiable.
2	**NS-6** 1094 Rock Ave, San Jose 95131 Open listing	$1.598M $874/sq ft	1,828 sq ft 3/2.5	15-20 min	20/25	Best value per sq ft that meets the commute: 1,828 sq ft, built 2005, 2-car garage, $1.598M ($874/sqft), 15-20 min. Downsides: small lot, Flood Factor 5/10 and an industrial-edge street.
3	**SV-4** 1181 Blazingwood Dr, Sunnyvale 94089 (Lakewood Village) Open listing	$1.500M $982/sq ft	1,528 sq ft 3/2	8-12 min	20/25	Closest commute (8-12 min) and best school (Fairwood 9/10): remodeled 3/2, 1,528 sq ft, 2-car garage, only $1.5M. It's a quick investor flip - insist on permits and a full inspection.

#	Home	Price	Size	Commute	Score	Why consider it
4	**SV-8** 348 Angel Ave, Sunnyvale 94086 Open listing	$1.988M $819/sq ft	2,428 sq ft 5/4 (incl. 1/1 ADU)	10-14 min	19/25	Brand-new 2026 build, 2,428 sq ft with a 1-bed ADU, 10-14 min commute. The $1.988M price is a bidding-war starter after asking $2.98M - expect it to sell well above budget.
5	**SC-1** 3021 Santa Maria Ave, Santa Clara 95051 (Bowers Crest) Open listing	$1.799M $1,134/sq ft	1,586 sq ft 4/3 (2 primary suites)	12-18 min	19/25	Fresh listing at $1.799M, below the city median $/sqft: 4 bed / 3 bath with two primary suites, 2-car garage, 12-18 min. Expect multiple offers; confirm the school.
6	**SC-3** 646 Bucher Ave, Santa Clara 95051 (Mariposa Gardens) Open listing	$1.988M $1,310/sq ft	1,518 sq ft 3/2	15-20 min	19/25	Remodeled 3/2 with EV-ready 2-car garage on a quiet street near Millikin (10/10, choice school). 82 days on market, so room to negotiate below $1.988M.
7	**NS-9** 1873 Silkwood Ln, San Jose 95131 Open listing	$1.598M $874/sq ft	1,828 sq ft 3/2.5	15-20 min	18/25	Twin of NS-6 (2007, 1,828 sq ft, 3/2.5, 2-car) at $1.598M with 15-20 min commute; same small-lot and flood caveats.
8	**SV-7** 1213 Manet Dr, Sunnyvale 94087 Open listing	$1.998M $1,287/sq ft	1,552 sq ft 3/2.5	16-20 min	18/25	Quiet, low-crime southwest Sunnyvale with a Cupertino USD address (Stocklmeir 10/10 claimed - verify). Tiny 2,755 sq ft lot; 96 days on market, so negotiable.
9	**SV-1** 807 S Wolfe Rd, Sunnyvale 94086 Open listing	$2.099M $1,298/sq ft	1,617 sq ft 4/2 + office	12-16 min	18/25	4 bed + office on a 7,000 sq ft lot, 12-16 min commute - but $2.099M (5% over budget) and it fronts 4-lane Wolfe Rd.
10	**NS-5** 1317 Dryden Dr, San Jose 95131 (Berryessa) Open listing	$1.650M $1,073/sq ft	1,538 sq ft 3/2.5	20-25 min (over limit)	22/25	Highest raw score (fully verified, Vinci Park 8/10, safe Berryessa) at $1.65M, but the commute is 20-25 min, just over your limit, and it will likely get bid up.

Score = Safety + Livability + Value + 2 × Verification (each 1–5, max 25). Homes that meet the 20-minute commute are ranked first; NS-5 and NS-7 score well but are 20–25 minutes away. Full details for all homes are in the Excel file.

Surroundings of the top picks

Home	Grocery	Elementary school	Hospital (ER)	Safety & hazards
SC-7 15-20 min	Lucky/Safeway on El Camino ~1 mi (est.)	Bracher Elem (Santa Clara USD) 6/10, 0.27 mi; Bowers 7/10 0.43 mi	Kaiser Santa Clara Medical Center (ER) ~2 mi	Santa Clara violent crime below US average (city-data); flood zone likely X - verify; possible San Tomas Expwy noise.
SC-5 15-18 min	Safeway/Lucky, Homestead Rd ~1 mi (est.)	C.W. Haman Elem (Santa Clara USD) 6/10, 0.4 mi; Millikin 10/10 nearby (choice school)	Kaiser Santa Clara (ER) ~1.5-2 mi	Central Santa Clara, average-to-low crime; away from the Bay so lower flood/liquefaction risk (verify).
NS-6 15-20 min	99 Ranch Market, Milpitas Square ~2 mi (est.)	Orchard Elem K-8 (Orchard SD) 5/10, 0.3 mi	Regional Medical Center of San Jose (ER) ~5 mi	Mixed residential/industrial Oakland Rd area, crime ~San Jose average; Redfin Flood Factor 5/10 - flood insurance likely; rail/truck noise.
SV-4 8-12 min	New Wing Yuan Market, Lakewood Shopping Center ~0.5 mi	Fairwood Elem (Sunnyvale SD) 9/10, 0.3 mi; Fremont High 9/10	Kaiser Santa Clara (ER) ~2.5 mi	Sunnyvale crime below CA average (NeighborhoodScout); Flood Factor 1/10; Hwy 237/Lawrence noise ~0.5 mi.
SV-8 10-14 min	Safeway on El Camino / downtown ~0.8 mi (est.)	Bishop Elem (Sunnyvale SD) 7/10, 0.7 mi; Fremont High 9/10	Kaiser Santa Clara (ER) ~3 mi	Central Sunnyvale, crime near city average; possible Caltrain/Central Expwy noise.

Home	Grocery	Elementary school	Hospital (ER)	Safety & hazards
SC-1 12-18 min	Bowers Plaza / El Camino centers ~0.9 mi	Likely Bowers Elem (Santa Clara USD) 7/10, ~0.5-1 mi	Kaiser Santa Clara (ER) ~1.5 mi	Santa Clara violent crime about half the US rate (city-data); flood zone likely X; occasional SJC aircraft noise.

Distances and commute times are estimates – confirm on Google Maps at rush hour, and check school assignment by address with the district.

Listings to avoid

NS-2 / NS-3 / NS-4	Pyrus Place (Epic Way) new builds are 3-story townhouses with $370+/mo HOA, not detached houses.
SV-5 / SV-6 / NS-12	No garage (SV-6's main house is also only ~960 sq ft).
SC-6 (caution)	Pre-foreclosure: cheap, but lender approval, timing and as-is condition make it a risky first purchase.

Before you make an offer

- Get a **mortgage pre-approval** (at $2M a jumbo loan is likely) and budget ~1.2% a year property tax (~$24K), insurance and any HOA / Mello-Roos.
- Read the **disclosure package** (TDS, SPQ, Natural Hazard Disclosure) before offering; many homes here have pre-inspections.
- Order **home and termite inspections**; for remodels and flips, pull city **permit history** and compare to the listing.
- Check the **FEMA flood zone** (msc.fema.gov), liquefaction maps, and get an insurance quote including earthquake cover.
- For ADUs, confirm the ADU is permitted and how it is metered; for new builds, confirm the final inspection / certificate of occupancy.
- Review the **preliminary title report**; decide which contingencies (loan, appraisal, inspection) you can keep – competitive homes here often go non-contingent.
- Drive the commute at rush hour and confirm the assigned elementary school by address.

Best websites to keep searching

- **Zillow** – Largest US portal; Zestimates and price/tax history. Blocks automated reading - browse it yourself.
- **Redfin** – Fast MLS updates, sold comps, Flood Factor and school data; partly blocked for automated reading.
- **Realtor.com** – MLS-fed listings, often the most up-to-date status (pending/contingent).
- **Homes.com** – Clean city/ZIP lists with price-drop tags; main source for this shortlist.
- **MLSListings** – The Bay Area MLS itself; city market stats (median, $/sqft, days on market).
- **Brokerage sites (Compass, Coldwell Banker, Sereno, RE/MAX)** – Full MLS detail pages that usually load when portals block.
- **GreatSchools** – School ratings and assigned-school lookups by address.
- **FEMA Flood Map Service Center** – Official flood zone for each address (affects insurance).

Sources

Listings: homes.com city/ZIP pages (Oct 27, 2026); MLSListings ML82058420 (2831 Monroe), ML82053595 (2527 Malone), ML82056880 (646 Bucher), ML82063878 (3021 Santa Maria); Coldwell Banker, Compass, RE/MAX, Sereno detail pages
Market: MLSListings Santa Clara market stats Sep 2026 ($1.817M median, $1,212/sqft); aegishomesre.com Mountain View YTD 2026 ($2.98M); julianalee.com Sunnyvale and 95131/95134 sales reports
Marvell address: marvell.com/company/offices
Schools: GreatSchools and Niche school pages; Santa Clara USD, Sunnyvale SD, Cupertino USD, Berryessa Union SD
Safety: city-data.com Santa Clara crime 2025; NeighborhoodScout Sunnyvale 2024; Niche Berryessa; Redfin/First Street Flood Factor; San Jose Inside (Regional Medical Center trauma closure 2024)

This report is research support, not legal, tax or financial advice. Listings change daily – confirm status and price with the listing agent.